

MARYLAND · VIRGINIA · WASHINGTON D.C.



THE NOVARACLEANING STANDARD

Operator *Handbook*

*Standards, expectations, and the way we deliver every clean. Your
guide to the NovaraCleaning standard.*

EDITION 1.0 · 2026

NOVARA CLEANING LLC

01

WELCOME

You're Part of Something *Built Different*

Welcome to NovaraCleaning — where we don't just clean homes across the DMV; we hand people back their time, their calm, and a space they're proud to live in.

As part of this team you are not just a cleaner. You are the reason a client opens their door, exhales, and immediately texts their neighbor about us. Our three values — **Devotion, Value, Care** — are the standard, and every job you complete carries them.

OUR MISSION

To redefine the cleaning experience across Maryland, Virginia, and Washington D.C. by delivering reliable, detail-obsessed service — turning every room into proof that a clean home changes how a day feels. We're not maintaining spaces; we're elevating them, and building trust through unmatched attention to detail and outstanding customer service.

WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT

Professionalism. We field dependable professionals who shine as brightly as the surfaces they clean.

Reliability. Our word is our bond. We show up, we deliver, and we leave clients so happy they tell their friends and family.

The standard drives the flywheel. Every clean reflects the brand. The brand drives the marketing. The marketing fills the schedule that pays you.

02 YOUR ROLE

The Face & the *Force* of the Brand

As a 1099 independent contractor with NovaraCleaning, you are both the face and the force of our brand. Your skill and attention to detail are what make a premium clean possible — and what build the reputation that keeps sending you more jobs.

THE BASICS & BEYOND

Master the basic clean checklist for each room type (Section 5). Then add the finishing touches. It's in the details:

- Fluffing the pillows and folding blankets
- Aligning the towels just so
- Polishing every glass surface until it doesn't just shine — it sparkles
- Replacing trash liners and wiping cans inside and out
- Squaring shoes by the door, straightening rugs, leaving the home composed

NOTE

Interior windows are a separate add-on service and are not included in standard or deep cleans.

OWN YOUR WORK

If a client isn't satisfied with your first pass, the encore is on you. We treat feedback as a chance to do better. As covered in onboarding: it is your responsibility to make sure the client is happy — even if that means a return trip on the original payment. We do whatever it takes. Things happen — but five-star is the standard we aim for, and it's what lets us command premium pricing and pay you well.

THE FLYWHEEL

Great service → great reviews → premium pricing → premium pay → better cleaners → great service. **You are the engine.**

WHAT NOT TO DO

- **Cut corners.** We don't skip steps.
- **Forget the finishing touches.** The little things elevate a clean to the Novara standard.
- **Take off-platform work from a NovaraCleaning client.** See the Non-Solicitation and Off-Platform clauses in the Contractor Agreement. This ends the relationship immediately.

03 RELIABILITY

Your *Livelihood*

Your health and safety come first. Delivering five-star service on every job means balancing performance with reliability. Some of us push through when we're under the weather — but if you ever can't make a clean within 24 hours due to illness, we expect to hear from you the moment you know. Early notice eliminates chargebacks and keeps us from losing the clients assigned to you.

The leads we convert into clients can cost **\$80–\$150 in ad spend**, so helping us keep them by showing up matters enormously. The less we pay for leads, the more we can pay you. That said — illness happens and family emergencies come up. Just tell us as soon as you know, through the LeadConnector app or by text.

BOTTOM LINE

The less we spend replacing canceled jobs, the more we can pay per clean. **Reliability is compensation.**

THE SCORING SYSTEM

Novara runs on a performance scoring system that evaluates every contractor on four things. The system rewards consistency, reliability, and quality — and directly affects how many jobs flow to you:

- **Acceptance Rate** — how often you accept jobs offered to you versus decline.
- **On-Time Rate** — tracked through Apploye clock-ins against the scheduled start.
- **Jobs Completed** — total verified volume. More quality jobs build more trust.
- **Customer Reviews** — your post-job ratings. Good reviews lift your score; poor ones lower it.

Acknowledgment of Sections 1–3

INITIAL

DATE

04 PAY & PRICING

How You *Get Paid*

HOW IT WORKS

Contractors are paid a **percentage of each completed job, weekly**, by direct deposit through Stripe — or by Zelle if you prefer; let us know during onboarding. Payments are based on completed and verified jobs. No taxes or deductions are withheld — as a 1099 contractor, you're responsible for your own taxes.

Your percentage grows as you grow with us, through our three-tier Ascension Program. Each job pays your tier's set percentage of the booking total, regardless of how long the job takes. The faster and cleaner you work, the higher your effective hourly rate. 100% of tips are yours.

TIER	% PER JOB	\$239 STANDARD	\$478 MOVE-IN	REQUIREMENTS
Foundation	35%	\$83.65	\$167.30	0–6 months · 4.8★+
Proven	40%	\$95.60	\$191.20	6+ mo · 25+ jobs · 90% on-time
Elite	45%	\$107.55	\$215.10	12+ mo · 50+ jobs · 95% on-time

HOURLY-CAP ADHERENCE

Almost every job has a built-in hour cap based on the scope priced. Example: a 6-hour cap means one cleaner for 6 hours OR two cleaners for 3 hours each.

- Notify the office 1–2 hours in advance if you think the job will exceed the cap, with a brief reason and photos if helpful.
- We'll seek client approval to extend before any extra time is worked, and let you know if they decline.
- Time worked beyond the cap without prior approval is not guaranteed compensation.

TIPS

Tips are 100% yours. Cash tips are yours on the spot. Tips added digitally are passed through in full on your next pay cycle.

THE DEAL

Premium pay requires premium output. Our pricing model is built so a great cleaner makes great money — **but only because the work justifies the rate to the client.**

05 STANDARDS

Basic Clean *Checklist*

This is the baseline. Every room, every visit. Use it as a closing checklist before you call a job done.

Kitchen

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Inside microwave | ☐ Backsplash |
| ☐ Stovetop | ☐ Exterior of trash can |
| ☐ Outside of appliances | ☐ Sweep floors |
| ☐ Empty trash, replace liner | ☐ Mop floors |
| ☐ Wipe shelves | ☐ Countertops |
| ☐ Glass surfaces (mirrors, frames) | ☐ Sink scrubbed & faucets polished |

Bathroom

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Shower | ☐ Toilets |
| ☐ Tub | ☐ Sweep & mop floors |
| ☐ Polish faucets | ☐ Counters & shelves |
| ☐ Mirrors & glass surfaces | ☐ Sink |
| ☐ Empty trash | |

Living & Laundry Rooms

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Glass surfaces (mirrors, frames) | ☐ Counters & horizontal surfaces |
| ☐ Empty trash | ☐ Light dusting of furniture |
| ☐ Shelves | ☐ Sweep & mop floors |
| ☐ Outside of appliances | ☐ Vacuum floors & rugs |
| ☐ Pillows fluffed, blankets folded | ☐ Sinks |

Bedrooms

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Sweep & mop or vacuum floors | ☐ Empty trash |
| ☐ Make beds | ☐ Light dusting of furniture |
| ☐ Glass surfaces (mirrors, frames) | ☐ Wipe shelves |



DEEP CLEAN ADDS

Deep cleans (and most first-time / move-in / move-out cleans) include everything in the basic checklist **plus**: most vertical surfaces (doors, door trims); kitchen cabinet doors; wet-wiping baseboards; wet-wiping window frames; dusting ceiling fans; wiping down furniture and vacuuming if needed; top of fridge dusted and wiped. Move-in/move-out cleans also include inside the fridge and inside the oven.

06

OPERATIONS

How We Run *Every Job*

Your role is crucial to our reputation for quality. The protocols below keep performance consistent across the whole team.

PHOTOGRAPHY PROTOCOL

- **Before and after photos of every room you work in. No exceptions.**
- Capture from the same angle each time for consistency.
- Hold the camera steady to avoid blur, and use good lighting — open blinds if needed.

WHY IT MATTERS

These photos feed the social content that grows the company — which means more jobs for you. They're also evidence of completed work, cutting down chargebacks, re-cleans, and refunds.

TIMEKEEPING (APPLOYE)

- Mark yourself en route in the LeadConnector app when you leave for a job.
- Clock in through **Apploye** before you enter the client's home — you don't need to wait until you start working. Late clock-ins trigger our no-show alerts.
- Clock out after the final walkthrough is complete.

CLIENT INTERACTION — FINAL WALKTHROUGH

- Invite the client to do a final walkthrough as you wrap up.
- You don't need to accompany them unless they ask.
- Offer to touch up any areas they notice were missed.
- If a phone call is needed for the client to confirm, it'll be noted in the job details.

DIGITAL CONFIRMATION — PREVENTING CHARGEBACKS & RE-CLEANS

During the walkthrough, have the client confirm the job is complete — or that the maximum working hours were reached — through the job confirmation in the app. This confirmation is your single best protection against pay adjustments, discounting, and re-cleans.

TEAM COMMUNICATION

When paired up, communicate clearly about tasks completed and in progress. That way, if a re-clean is needed, only the responsible cleaner is sent back to address it.

07

CONDUCT

Client Requests & *Dress Code*

SPECIAL REQUESTS

If a client requests something you're uncomfortable with, step away and consult the management team. For requests like not reusing microfibers from other homes, clients may provide their own materials — management will back you up if needed.

EXTRA SERVICES & THE 5-MINUTE RULE

- Don't let clients take advantage of unused time within the maximum working hours.
- **5-Minute Rule:** if a special request takes 5 minutes or less and isn't part of our standard checklist, you may fulfill it. (Bed-making is an exception — you may do it on request, though it isn't standard.)
- Larger tasks — like cleaning the inside of a fridge — are paid add-ons and should not be done without proper charges. Call the office.

DRESS CODE & PROFESSIONALISM

- Wear shirts with sleeves around clients. (Exception: move-in/move-out cleans or vacant properties with no client on-site.)
- Wear pants or shorts with adequate coverage that stay appropriate in all positions.
- Avoid graphic shirts — especially those depicting blood or political messages.
- Closed-toe shoes. No exceptions.

08

CLOSING

Conclusion & *Feedback*

Your adherence to these guidelines keeps NovaraCleaning's standards high and our clients satisfied. Thank you for your dedication to excellence.

FEEDBACK & GROWTH

We're all about growth. If you have an idea about a product, a service, or any way we run the business — reach out. We're always looking for ways to be the best we can be, so that every client wants to tell their friends and family after you do phenomenal work. The line is always open.

Acknowledgment of Handbook

I have read and understood the above expectations and agree to comply with them as part of my contract with NovaraCleaning, LLC.

CONTRACTOR SIGNATURE

DATE